

Private Aircraft For All

During the 1930s, General Aviation really began to gather momentum. Inspired by events such as Sir Alan Cobham's National Aviation Day displays and films like *Hell's Angels* and *The Dawn Patrol*, interest in sport flying grew exponentially, and manufacturers on both sides of the Atlantic strove to produce suitable machines for this expanding market.

△ de Havilland DH82A Tiger Moth 1931

Origin UK

Engine 130 hp de Havilland Gipsy Major I air-cooled inverted inline 4

Top speed 109 mph (175 km/h)

Based on the DH Gipsy Moth, the DH Tiger Moth was designed as a military trainer. The type was very successful, with more than 8,800 being built. Many survivors remain airworthy today.

▷ Stampe SV4C(G) 1933

Origin Belgium/France

Engine 145 hp de Havilland Gipsy Major X air-cooled inline 4

Top speed 116 mph (186 km/h)

Designed as an improvement on the DH Tiger Moth, the Stampe offered a slightly more modern design, much better handling, and superior aerobatic capabilities. Eventually almost 1,000 would be built, many in France and mostly for the French Air Force.

△ de Havilland DH87B Hornet Moth 1934

Origin UK

Engine 130 hp de Havilland Gipsy Major I air-cooled inverted inline 4

Top speed 124 mph (200 km/h)

Another of de Havilland's series of Moth biplanes, the Hornet Moth featured a fully enclosed cockpit and side-by-side seating. Popular with private owners, of the 164 built several still survive, being much prized by their collectors.

▽ Taylor E2 Cub (converted) 1930

Origin US

Engine 35 hp Szekeley air-cooled 3-cylinder radial

Top speed 70 mph (113 km/h)

The E2 was the first Taylor/Piper aircraft to bear the Cub name. Originally fitted with a 37 hp Continental A40 flat-4, this aircraft was converted to the H2 specification with the Szekeley engine. Around 350 were built.

△ Stinson V.77 Reliant 1933

Origin US

Engine 300 hp Lycoming R-680 air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 177 mph (285 km/h)

The Stinson Reliant was produced over a 10-year period, in literally dozens of versions and powered by many different radial engines. Operated by the USAAF, RAF, and RN, later models are easily identified by the gull-wing configuration.

△ de Havilland DH94 Moth Minor 1939

Origin UK

Engine 90 hp de Havilland Gipsy Minor air-cooled inverted inline 4

Top speed 118 mph (190 km/h)

The last de Havilland design to be called Moth, the DH94 Moth Minor was an elegant monoplane that was descended from the earlier Swallow Moth. Aimed directly at the flying club market it initially sold well, although the outbreak of WWII caused production to cease after barely 140 had been produced.